



Palo Alto Cortex XDR Connector — Credential Provisioning Guide

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Overview

The Crogl Palo Alto Cortex XDR connector reads **alerts**, **incidents**, and **endpoint inventory** from the Cortex XDR public API using a single **Standard API key**. There is no OAuth flow and no app registration — one API key, paired with its API Key ID and tenant API host, is enough to authenticate every endpoint this connector uses.

Generating that key requires access to the Cortex API-key management UI. If you're an FDE walking a customer through this live, expect their Cortex administrator to drive the console while you confirm the resulting values.

IMPORTANT

This guide was written from Palo Alto Networks' published Cortex XDR 5.x API and provisioning documentation, not from a live tenant. The menu paths below come directly from those docs and should be treated as docs-grounded guidance. If the customer's console labels differ slightly, follow the nearest equivalent UI.

NOTE

Cortex XDR offers two API-key types: **Standard** and **Advanced**. This Crogl connector supports **Standard** keys only. Advanced keys require a per-request `SHA256(api_key + nonce + timestamp)` authorization hash plus `x-xdr-nonce` and `x-xdr-timestamp` headers, which Crogl's static credential binding cannot generate.

What kind of account to create

Cortex XDR does **not** require a separate service account or app registration for this connector. Instead, create an **API key** in the customer's Cortex tenant and assign it a role.

Per Palo Alto's docs, the role selected during key creation can be a predefined or custom role coming from Cortex Gateway / Cortex XSIAM access management. Use the narrowest role that still allows the key to **read alerts**, **read incidents**, and **read endpoint inventory**. Do not assign a write-capable or administrator-level role just because an administrator is the one generating the key.

If the customer uses Scope-Based Access Control (SBAC), the key can also be scoped during creation. If you apply scope restrictions, confirm the chosen scope still covers the data Crogl needs to query.

Permissions to grant

The vendor docs reviewed for this build do not publish one canonical permission-name list specifically for the three read endpoints this connector uses. Because of that, the safest guidance is:

- Assign a role that can **read alerts**.
- Assign a role that can **read incidents**.
- Assign a role that can **read endpoints / endpoint inventory**.
- Keep the key type at **Standard**.
- If SBAC is enabled, ensure the scope includes the relevant endpoint groups / incident visibility

the customer expects Crogl to see.

IMPORTANT

If the tenant uses a custom RBAC model, verify the exact effective permissions with the customer's Cortex administrator before assuming a predefined role is sufficient. The connector is read-only and does not need response-action, incident-edit, or endpoint-mutation permissions.

Generating the credential

1. Sign in to Cortex XDR.
2. Navigate to **Settings > Configurations > Integrations > API Keys**.
3. Select **New Key**.
4. In the **Role** tab:
 - a. Under **Security Level**, choose **Standard**.
 - b. Under **Role**, select the desired read-oriented role.
 - c. Optionally add a **Comment** describing the key's purpose, for example **Crogl connector - read only**.
 - d. Optionally enable **Expiration Date** if the customer's credential-rotation policy requires it.
5. If the tenant uses SBAC and the customer wants this key scoped, open the **Scope** tab and configure the desired scope.
6. Select **Generate**.
7. **Copy the API key value immediately**, then select **Close**. This is the value Crogl stores as **api_key** and Cortex will not show it again after closing the dialog.

Getting the remaining values

You also need two additional values from the same API Keys page:

1. In the API Keys table, note the key's **ID** value. This is the **key_id** Crogl stores and sends as the **x-xdr-auth-id** header.
2. On the API Keys page, click **Copy API URL** (the docs also note you can use the **CURL Example URL**). This gives you the tenant-specific API URL.

Crogl does **not** want the full copied URL. It wants only the tenant host portion, stored as **api_host**.

Example:

Copied API URL example	Value to store in Crogl api_host
https://api-company.us.paloaltonetworks.com/public_api/v1/incidents/get_incidents	api-company.us.paloaltonetworks.com

Mapping values into Crogl

Three values map to `community/cortex-xdr/connector.json`'s `credential_schema.fields` when creating the connector instance in Crogl:

Crogl field	Where it came from	Notes
<code>api_host</code>	The host portion of the copied API URL / CURL Example	No <code>https://</code> prefix and no path — just the hostname, for example <code>api-company.us.paloaltonetworks.com</code> .
<code>key_id</code>	The API key's ID value from the API Keys table	Crogl sends this as the <code>x-xdr-auth-id</code> header.
<code>api_key</code>	The API key value shown once at generation time	Treat as a password. Never paste it into chat, a ticket, or this document.

Crogl combines these into requests such as `https://api-company.us.paloaltonetworks.com/public_api/v1/incidents/get_incidents` and attaches the stored headers automatically.

Verifying the setup

Right after creating the connector instance in Crogl, confirm the setup with a small read-only call:

- `cortex_xdr.py query-alerts --limit 1`
- `cortex_xdr.py query-incidents --limit 1`
- `cortex_xdr.py list-endpoints --limit 1`

Expected outcomes:

- **Success:** `HTTP 200` with one or more rows, or a valid empty result if the tenant simply has no matching data.
- **401:** the `api_key` value is wrong, truncated, expired, or the key was generated as **Advanced** rather than **Standard**.
- **403:** the key authenticated but the selected role or scope does not allow that resource. Widen the role or scope rather than re-copying the same credential.
- **Host / connection error before any Cortex response:** the `api_host` value is wrong or includes a scheme/path instead of just the hostname.
- **429 on extra incident detail:** `get_incident_extra_data` has a vendor-documented limit of **10 requests per minute**. Wait 60 seconds before retrying.

NOTE

The general Cortex XDR API docs also call out a tenant-wide rate limit of **10 requests per second**. For smoke tests, keep validation calls small and infrequent.